cPanel Database Setup

OnPoint sites: cleaning, security, engineering. Repeat once per site; each site has its own database.

1. Create the database

1. Log in to cPanel and open **MySQL® Databases**.
2. Under **Create New Database**, enter a name such as `onpoint_cleaning` and click **Create Database**.
3. cPanel adds your account prefix, so the real name looks like `cpaneluser_onpoint_cleaning`. Write down the full name.

2. Create a database user

1. Scroll to **MySQL Users → Add New User**.
2. Enter a username such as `onpoint` (real name becomes `cpaneluser_onpoint`).
3. Click **Password Generator**, copy the password somewhere safe, then click **Create User**.
4. The three sites can share one user, but separate users per site are safer.

3. Link the user to the database

1. Scroll to **Add User To Database**.
2. Pick the user and the database, then click **Add**.
3. Tick **ALL PRIVILEGES** and click **Make Changes**.

4. Import the schema

1. From the cPanel home page open **phpMyAdmin**.
2. Click your new database in the left sidebar. The import runs against whichever database is selected, so check this.
3. Open the **Import** tab and click **Choose File**.
4. Pick that site's own `schema.sql`:
   - `onpoint-cleaning/schema.sql`
   - `onpoint-security/schema.sql`
   - `onpoint-engineering/schema.sql`
5. Leave the defaults and click **Import**. Tables such as `admins` and `redirects` should appear in the sidebar.
6. If the database came from an older schema, also import `migrations/001_seo.sql` once. A fresh import already includes it.

5. Point the site at the database

1. Upload the site files to `public_html` using File Manager or FTP.
2. Copy `.env.example` to `.env`. In File Manager, turn on **Show Hidden Files** in Settings.

3. Edit these lines in `.env`:

```
DB_HOST=localhost
DB_PORT=3306
DB_NAME=cpaneluser_onpoint_cleaning   # full prefixed name
DB_USER=cpaneluser_onpoint            # full prefixed name
DB_PASS=<password from step 2>
INSTALL_KEY=<any 16+ random characters>
INDEXNOW_KEY=<32 random letters/digits>
```

4. Keep `DB_HOST=localhost`; that is correct on cPanel.
5. If the password contains special characters such as `#` or spaces, wrap it in quotes.

6. Check PHP settings

cPanel → **Select PHP Version**. Choose 8.1 or newer and enable `pdo_mysql`, `fileinfo` and `dom`.

7. Create the admin

1. Visit `https://yourdomain/install.php`. It only works when `INSTALL_KEY` is set and no admin exists yet.
2. Create the first admin account.
3. **Delete `install.php` from the server straight away.**
4. Sign in at `https://yourdomain/admin/`.
5. Make sure `uploads/` is set to 755 so uploads work.

Troubleshooting

- **"Database tables are missing"**: the import in step 4 went into the wrong database or failed. Re-import.
- **Connection errors**: usually a missing prefix on `DB_NAME` or `DB_USER`, a wrong password, or the user was not added to the database in step 3. Temporarily set `APP_DEBUG=true` for details, then set it back to `false`.
- **404 on install.php**: `INSTALL_KEY` is shorter than 16 characters, or an admin already exists.

> Never commit `.env` or share the database password.